

DAILY DRIVE

PERSONAL PRODUCTIVITY PLATFORM

USER MANUAL

Version 1.0 • April 2026

USER GUIDE

ADMINISTRATOR GUIDE

1. Introduction

1.1 About Daily Drive

Daily Drive is a full-featured personal productivity and task management web application. It gives individuals a single place to plan their day, track tasks through to completion, take notes, and stay on top of deadlines through a calendar and an automated notification system. The platform is split into two experiences: a User portal for day-to-day task and note management, and an Admin portal for account approval, oversight, and platform-wide analytics.

This manual explains every part of Daily Drive from both perspectives — how a regular user signs up, verifies their account, and manages tasks day to day, and how an administrator approves users and monitors activity across the platform. Screenshots from the live application are included throughout so each step can be followed visually.

1.2 Who This Manual Is For

- End users who want to organize tasks, notes, and their schedule using Daily Drive.
- Administrators responsible for approving new accounts and monitoring platform usage.
- New team members who need a quick reference to every screen in the application.

1.3 Key Features

- Secure sign-up with email verification (OTP) for both user and admin accounts.
- Role-based access with separate, purpose-built User and Admin portals.
- Full task management — create, update, prioritize, and track tasks with subtasks, attachments, and comments.
- A visual calendar showing task due dates at a glance.
- Rich notes with pinning and colour coding for quick organization.
- Custom task categories with colours and icons.
- In-app notifications plus automated reminders sent on a schedule.
- Admin analytics covering user activity and platform productivity.
- Per-user dark mode preference for comfortable use in any lighting.

1.4 Technology Overview

Daily Drive is built on a standard, reliable web stack:

Layer	Technology
Backend	Node.js with Express 4
Templating	EJS
Database	MySQL (via a promise-based connection pool)
Authentication	Passport.js (local strategy) with bcrypt password hashing
Email delivery	Nodemailer (used to send OTP verification codes)
Sessions	express-session

Scheduled jobs node-cron (automated reminders)

File uploads Multer (task attachments)

Note: This manual focuses on how to use Daily Drive day to day. Installation and server configuration details (environment variables, database setup, etc.) are covered separately in the project's technical README for developers and system administrators deploying the application.

2. Getting Started

2.1 Account Types

Daily Drive supports two kinds of accounts, selected at registration:

Account Type	Description
User	Standard account for personal task, note, and calendar management. Requires admin approval after email verification before it can be used to log in.
Admin	Elevated account for platform oversight. Requires a valid Admin Registration Key at sign-up and becomes active immediately after email verification, without needing separate approval.

2.2 The Registration & Verification Flow

Every new account, regardless of type, follows the same secure sign-up sequence:

1. Fill in the registration form with your name, email address, password, and account type.
2. Daily Drive generates a 6-digit One-Time Password (OTP) and emails it to the address provided.
3. You are redirected to the email verification screen.
4. Enter the OTP. Codes are valid for 10 minutes and allow a maximum of 5 attempts before a new code must be requested.
5. On successful verification, the account is created. User accounts are placed in a pending state awaiting admin approval; admin accounts are activated immediately.

Note: If a user account has not yet been approved by an administrator, sign-in will be blocked with a status message until approval is granted (see Section 4.6, User Management).

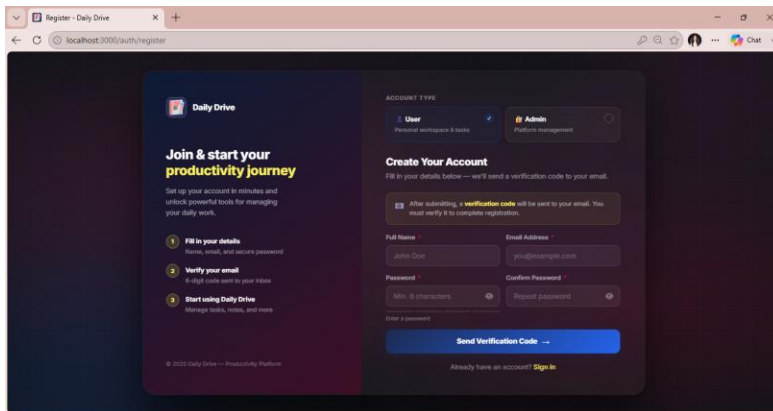
PART II

3. User Guide

Everything a Daily Drive user needs to plan, track, and complete their day.

3.1 Creating an Account

New users create an account from the registration screen, providing their full name, email address, and a password, and selecting the User account type.

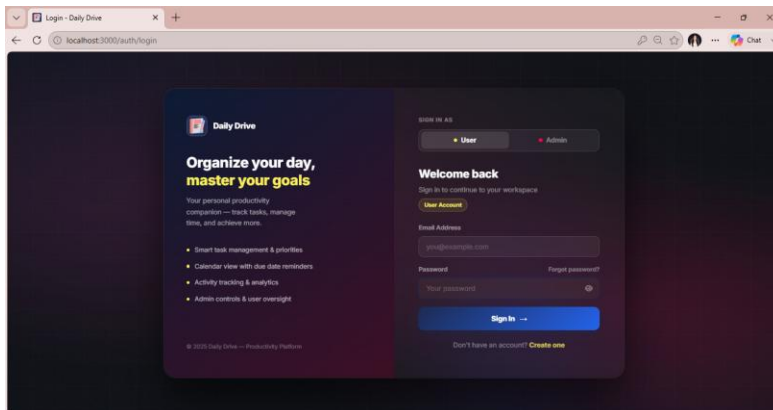


Registration screen

Fill in your name, email, and password, then choose "User" as the account type. After submitting, a 6-digit verification code is emailed to you to confirm your address.

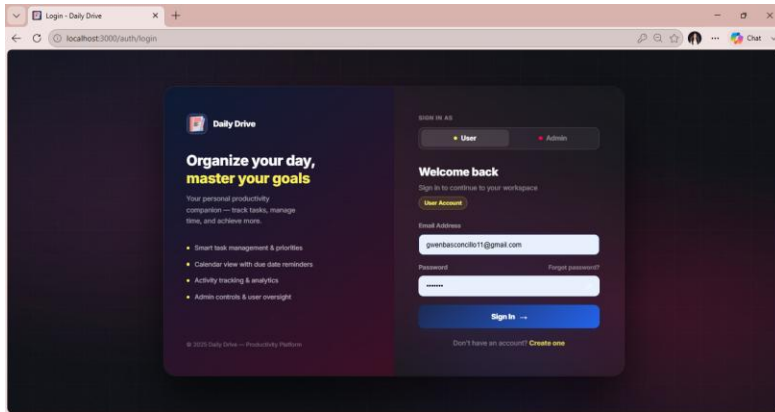
3.2 Signing In

Returning users sign in with their registered email and password from the login screen.



Sign-in screen

Choose the "User" tab, then enter your email address and password. A link to create an account is provided for anyone signing in for the first time.

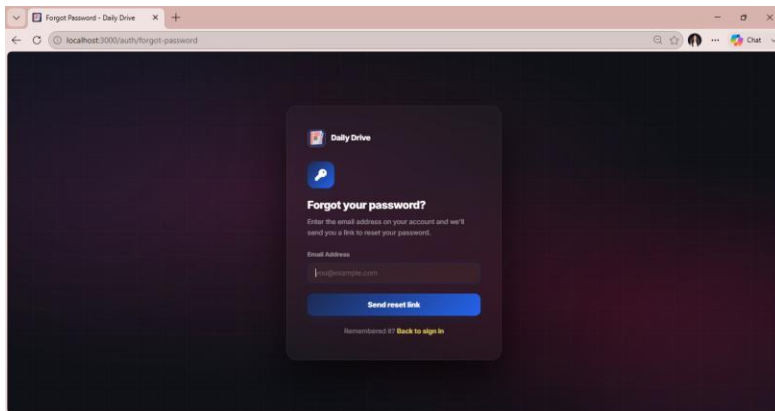


Sign-in, filled in

Once your credentials are entered, select Sign In to continue to your workspace.

3.3 Resetting Your Password

If you forget your password, use the Forgot Password link on the sign-in screen.

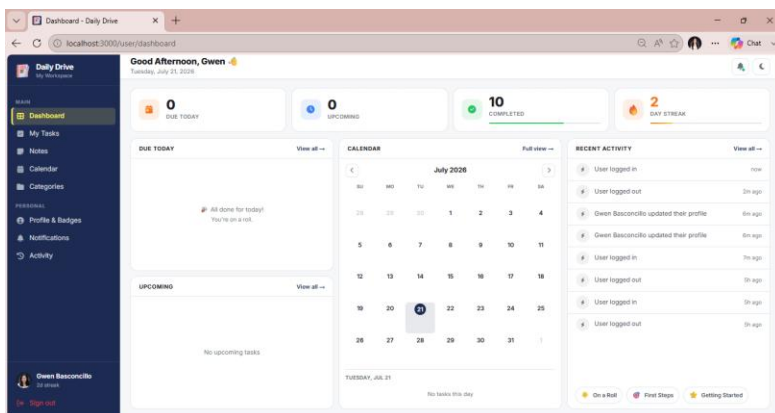


Forgot password

Enter the email address on your account and a password reset link will be sent to your inbox.

3.4 Dashboard Overview

After signing in, users land on the Dashboard — a snapshot of their productivity for the day.



Dashboard

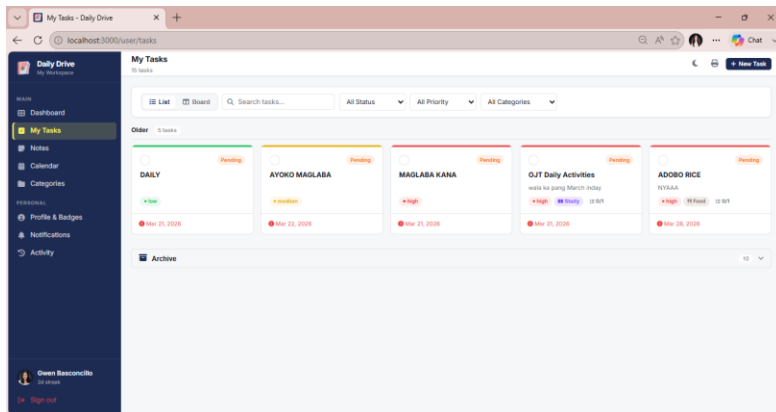
Summarizes tasks due today, upcoming tasks, completed tasks, and your current daily streak, alongside a mini calendar and a feed of recent account activity.

3.5 Managing Tasks

Task management is the core of Daily Drive. From My Tasks, users can create, edit, prioritize, and track work through to completion.

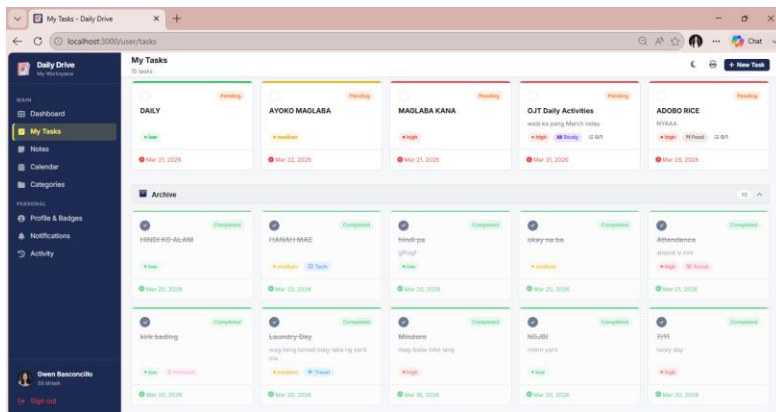
3.5.1 Task List & Filters

The task list shows all of a user's tasks and can be filtered by status, priority, or category, or searched directly.



My Tasks

Active tasks are grouped by due date, with priority, status, and category shown on each card.

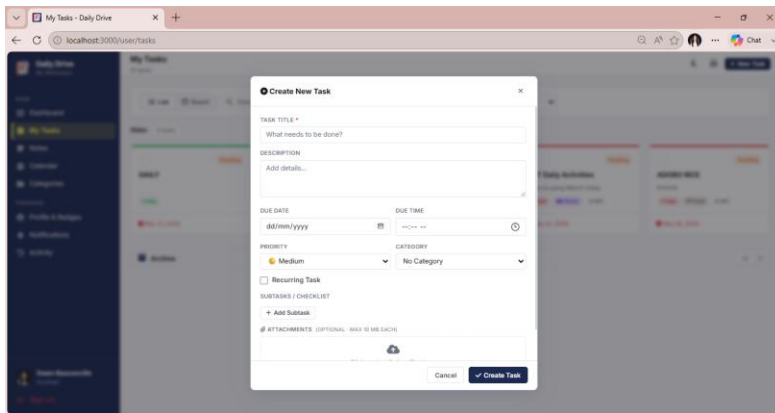


Archive, expanded

Completed tasks move into a collapsible Archive section, keeping the active list focused while still keeping history on hand.

3.5.2 Creating a New Task

Each task can be given a title, description, due date, time, priority, category, and optional subtasks or attachments.

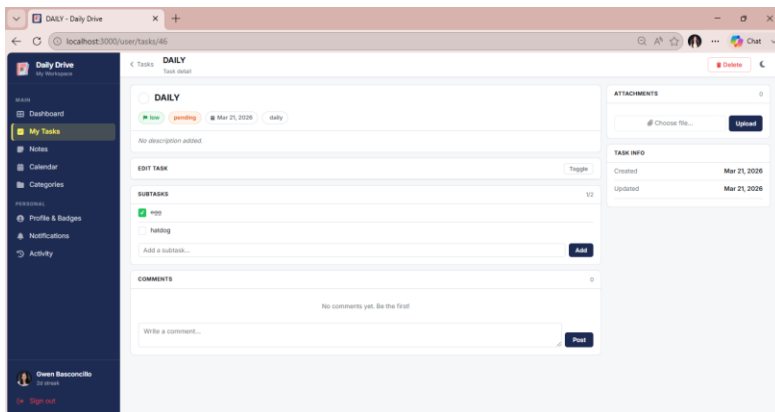


Create New Task

Set the task title and description, due date and time, priority, and category. Recurring tasks, subtasks/checklists, and file attachments (up to 10 MB each) can also be added.

3.5.3 Task Detail, Subtasks & Comments

Opening a task shows its full detail view, where progress can be tracked step by step.



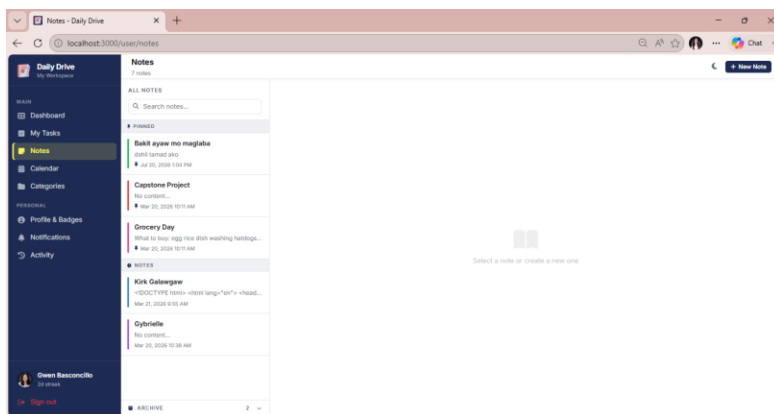
Task detail

Shows subtasks with progress (e.g. 1/2 complete), lets you add attachments and comments, and lists task info such as created and updated dates.

Note: Deleting a task also removes its subtasks, attachments, and comments. This action cannot be undone.

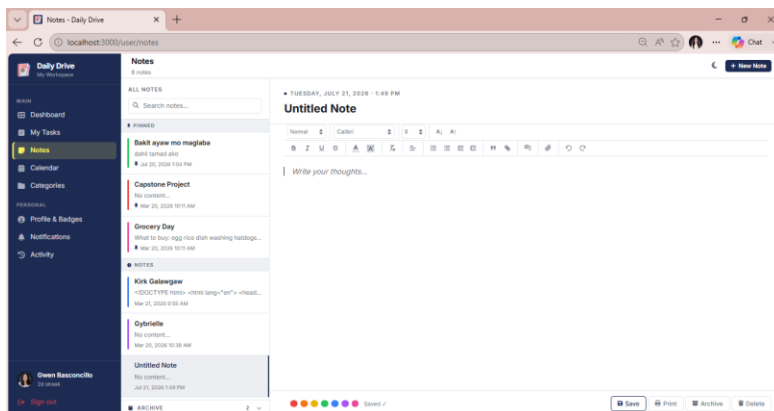
3.6 Notes

The Notes section is a lightweight space for anything that doesn't need to be tracked as a formal task. Notes can be pinned and colour-coded for quick visual grouping.



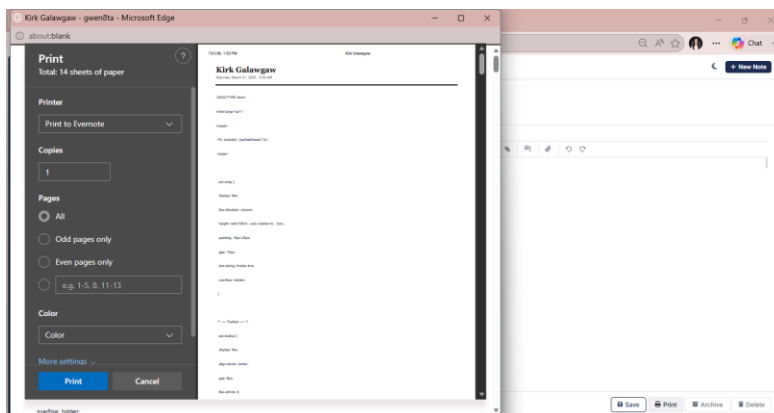
Notes list

Pinned notes stay at the top; all other notes are listed below with a preview and last-edited time.



Note editor

A rich text editor supports formatting, lists, links, and colour tags, with autosave as you type.

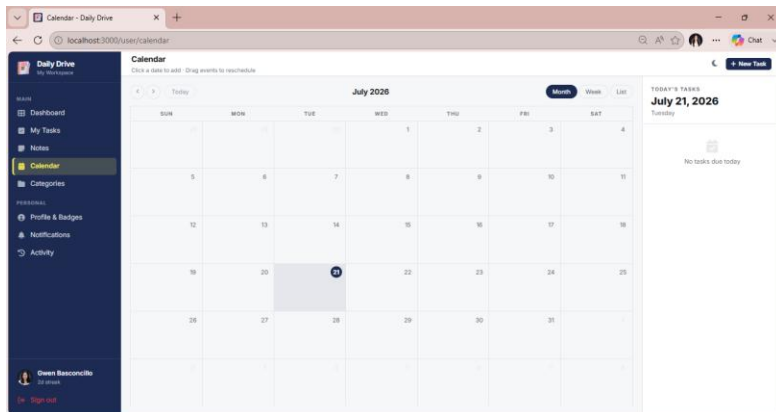


Printing a note

Any note can be printed directly from the editor toolbar using the browser's print dialog.

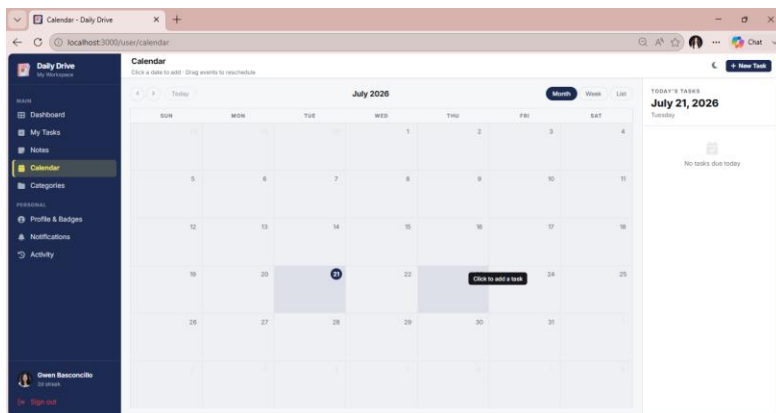
3.7 Calendar View

The Calendar gives a visual, month-at-a-glance view of every task's due date.



Month view

Days with tasks due are marked on the calendar; today's tasks are also listed in the side panel.

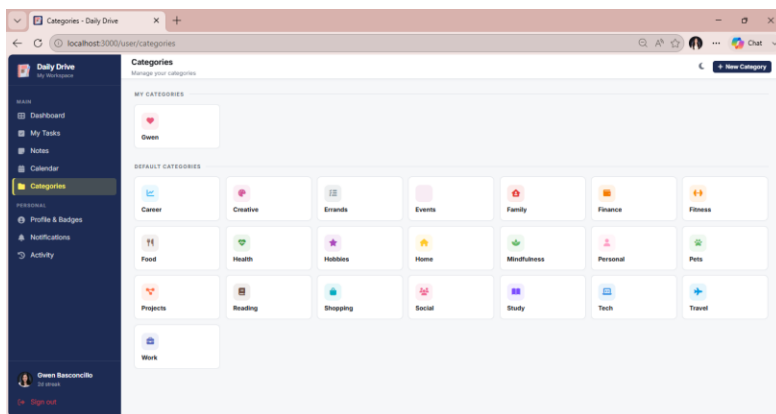


Add a task from the calendar

Clicking any date opens a quick prompt to add a new task due that day, or drag existing tasks to reschedule them.

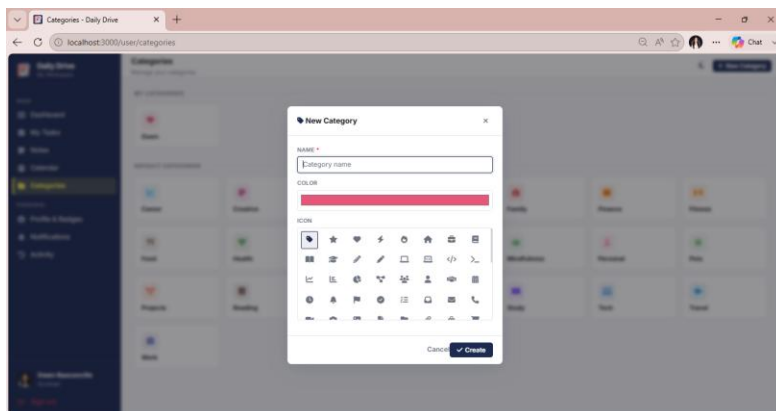
3.8 Categories

Categories let users group related tasks together. Each category can be given a custom colour and icon, which then appears throughout the task list and calendar.



Categories

Default categories (Work, Personal, Study, etc.) are provided out of the box, alongside any custom categories you create.

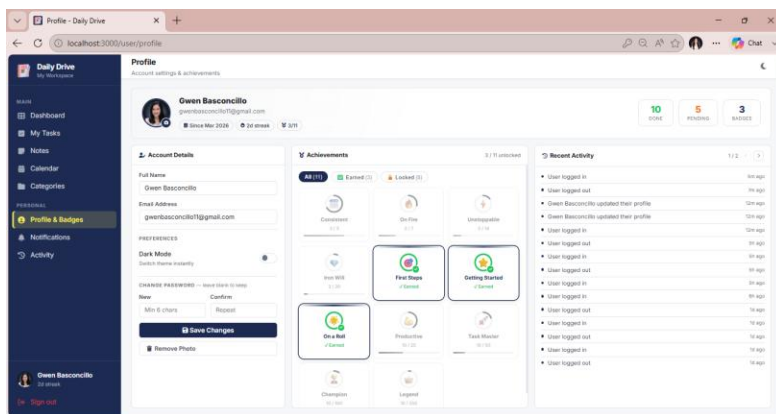


New Category

Choose a name, colour, and icon for the category. It will then be selectable from the task creation form.

3.9 Profile, Achievements & Preferences

The Profile screen lets users update their personal details, track achievement badges, and toggle Dark Mode — a preference saved per user.

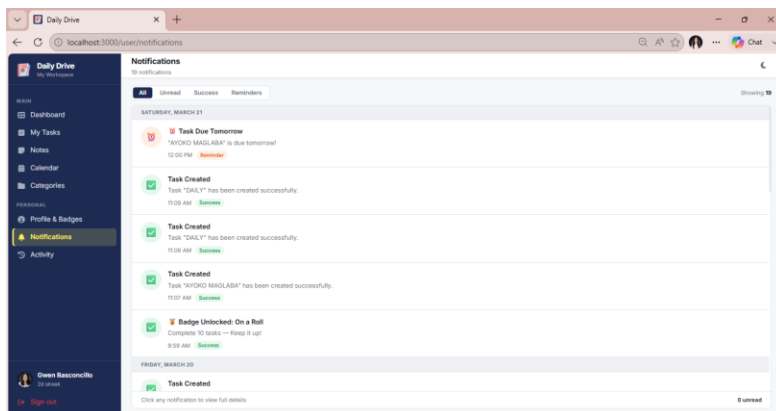


Profile

Update your name, email, and password; switch Dark Mode on or off instantly; and track progress toward achievement badges like "First Steps" and "On a Roll."

3.10 Notifications

Daily Drive keeps users informed with in-app notifications covering task activity, due-date reminders, and badge unlocks.

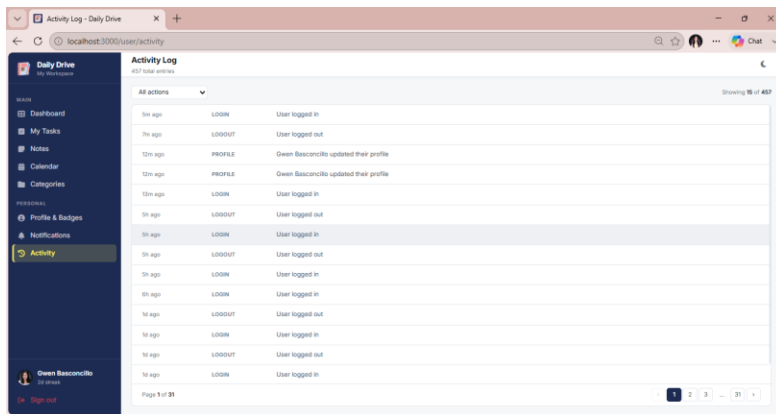


Notifications

Notifications can be filtered by Unread, Success, or Reminders, and are grouped by date for easy scanning.

3.11 Activity Log

Every sign-in, sign-out, and profile change is recorded in a personal activity log, giving users a transparent history of account activity.



Activity Log

A paginated, timestamped log of account events such as logins, logouts, and profile updates.

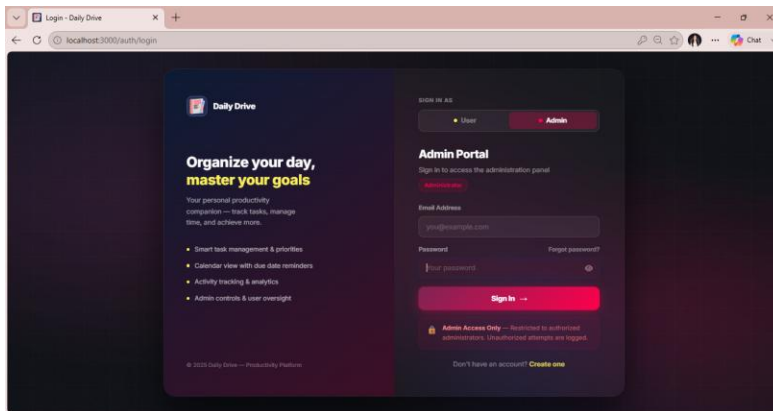
PART III

4. Admin Guide

Approve users, monitor activity, and keep the Daily Drive platform running smoothly.

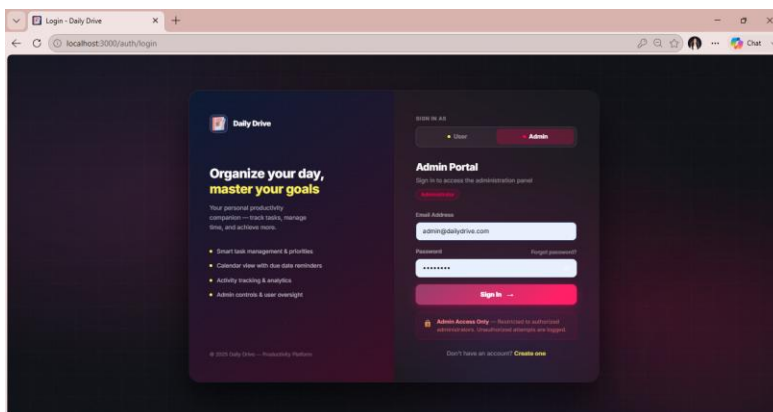
4.1 Admin Sign-In

Administrators sign in from the same login page as users, using the "Admin" tab. Access is restricted to authorized administrators only.



Admin Portal sign-in

Switch to the Admin tab and enter your administrator email and password. Unauthorized sign-in attempts are logged.

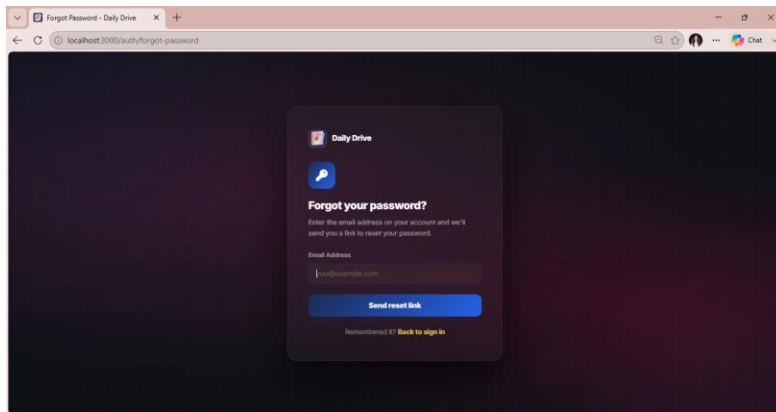


Admin sign-in, filled in

Once credentials are entered, selecting Sign In opens the Admin Dashboard.

4.2 Admin Password Reset

Administrators who forget their password use the same Forgot Password flow as regular users.

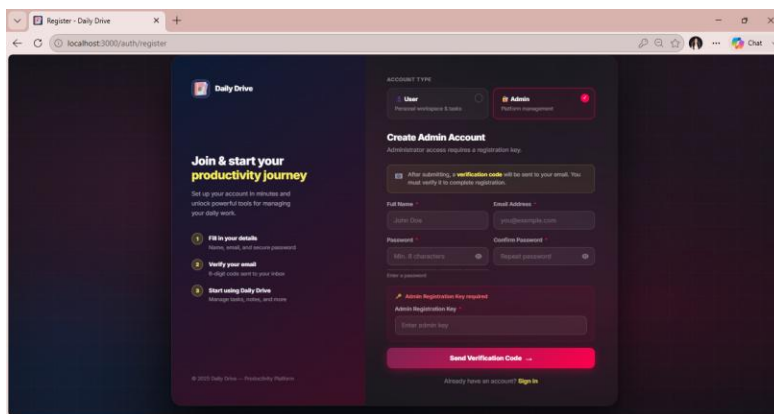


Forgot password

Enter the administrator email address to receive a password reset link.

4.3 Creating an Admin Account

Admin accounts are created through the registration screen, but require a valid Admin Registration Key issued by whoever deployed the platform.

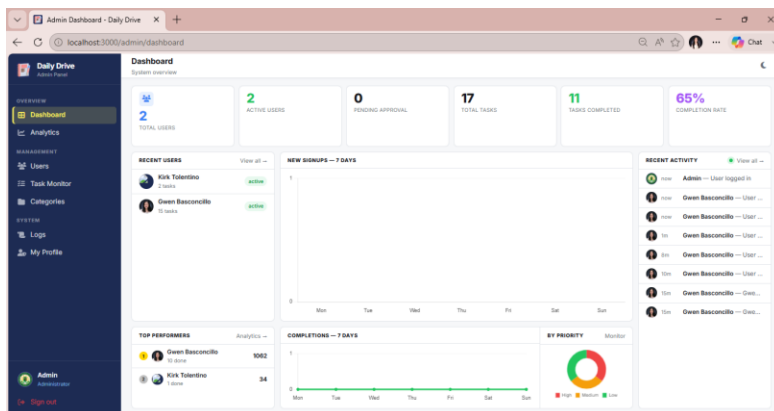


Admin registration

Select "Admin" as the account type and supply the Admin Registration Key along with name, email, and password. The account activates immediately after email verification — no separate approval step is needed.

4.4 Admin Dashboard

The Admin Dashboard gives a platform-wide view of activity.

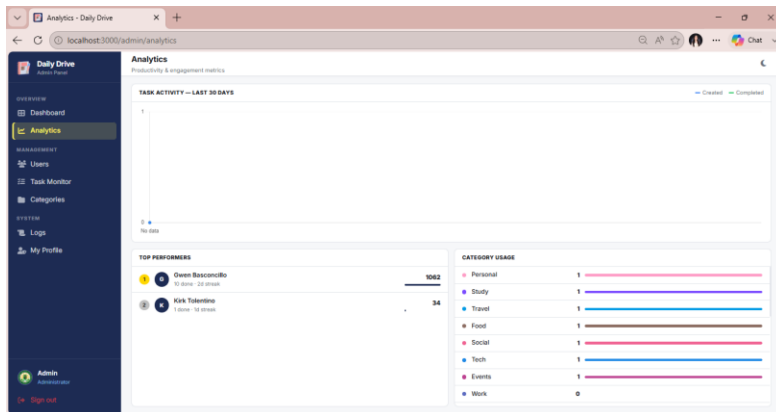


Admin Dashboard

Shows total users, active users, pending approvals, total tasks, completion rate, recent signups, top performers, and a live recent-activity feed.

4.5 Analytics & Reports

The Analytics screen breaks platform activity down further for deeper insight.



Analytics

Charts task activity over the last 30 days, ranks top-performing users, and shows category usage across the platform.

4.6 User Management

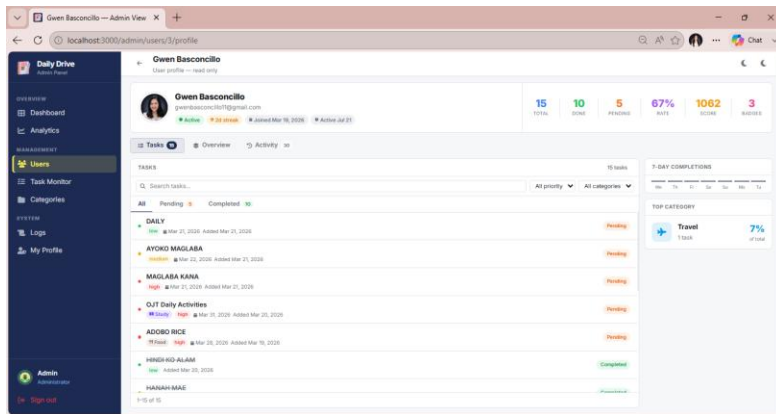
Every new user account must be approved by an administrator before it can sign in. The Users screen lists all registered accounts and their status.

The User Management dashboard allows administrators to manage registered accounts. It features a sidebar for navigation and a main content area with a search bar and a table of users.

#	USER	EMAIL	STATUS	TASKS	JOINED	ACTIONS
1	Kirk Tolentino 10 days - 10 tasks	kirktolentino@gmail.com	active	2	Mar 21, 2025	Deactivate
2	Owen Basconillo 10 days - 20 tasks	owenbasconillo@gmail.com	active	15	Mar 18, 2025	Deactivate

Users list

Search or filter users by status, and Activate or Deactivate any account directly from the list.



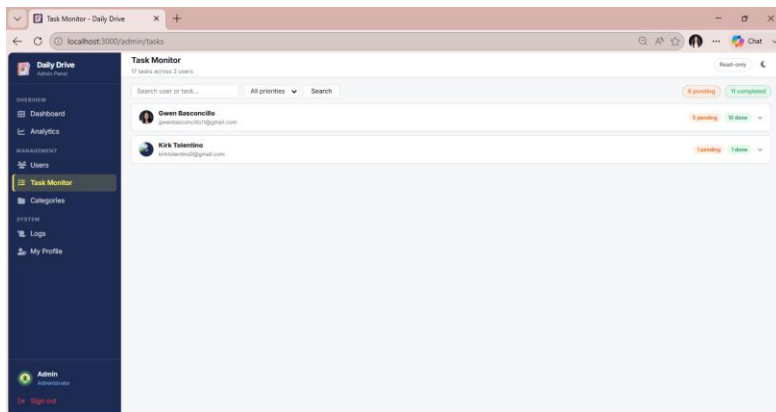
User detail (read-only)

Drill into an individual user's tasks, overall stats, completion rate, and score without being able to edit their content.

Note: Deactivating a user immediately blocks that account from signing in. This should be used carefully, as it directly affects the end user's access to their tasks and notes.

4.7 Task Oversight

Administrators can view task activity across every user account to monitor overall platform productivity.



Task Monitor

A read-only view of every user's pending and completed task counts, expandable for more detail per user.

4.8 Category Management

Administrators can review every category available across the platform, including how many tasks use it and whether it's visible to users.

CATEGORY	COLOR	ICON CLASS	TYPE	TASKS	VISIBLE	ACTIONS
Career	#007bff	fas fa-chart-line	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Creative	#ff69b4	fas fa-palette	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Events	#ff69b4	fas fa-list-check	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Family	#ff69b4	fas fa-calendar-star	Default	1	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Finance	#ff69b4	fas fa-wallet	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Fitness	#ff69b4	fas fa-dumbbell	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Food	#ff69b4	fas fa-utensils	Default	1	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Health	#ff69b4	fas fa-heartbeat	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Hobbies	#ff69b4	fas fa-star	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Home	#ff69b4	fas fa-home	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>
Mindfulness	#ff69b4	fas fa-seedling	Default	0	☐	<i>[edit]</i>

Categories (admin)

Lists each category's colour, icon, type (default or custom), task count, and visibility toggle.

4.9 System Logs

A platform-wide, timestamped log of account and system events across all users.

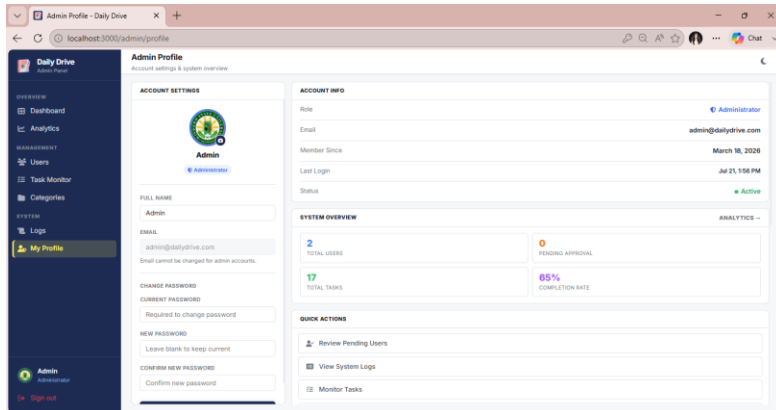
USER	ACTION	DESCRIPTION	TIME
Admin	login	User logged in	2m ago
Owen Basconcello	logout	User logged out	2m ago
Owen Basconcello	login	User logged in	2m ago
Owen Basconcello	logout	User logged out	3m ago
Owen Basconcello	login	User logged in	11m ago
Owen Basconcello	logout	User logged out	12m ago
Owen Basconcello	profile updated	Owen Basconcello updated their profile	17m ago
Owen Basconcello	profile updated	Owen Basconcello updated their profile	17m ago
Owen Basconcello	login	User logged in	18m ago
Admin	logout	User logged out	18m ago
Admin	login	User logged in	19m ago

System Logs

Searchable and filterable by action type, showing which user performed each action and when.

4.10 Admin Profile & Settings

Like users, administrators have their own profile screen to manage account details and preferences.



Admin Profile

Update account details and password, view system-wide totals at a glance, and jump to Review Pending Users, View System Logs, or Monitor Tasks via quick actions.

5. Quick Reference

5.1 User vs. Admin Capabilities

Capability	User	Admin
Register & verify email (OTP)	Yes	Yes
Requires approval before first login	Yes	No (active immediately)
Create / manage own tasks, notes, categories	Yes	N/A
View calendar of own tasks	Yes	N/A
Approve, reject, activate, deactivate users	No	Yes
View platform-wide analytics	No	Yes
Manage own profile & dark mode	Yes	Yes

5.2 Troubleshooting

Issue	Resolution
OTP not received screen.	Check spam/junk folder; use the Resend Code option on the verification screen.
OTP expired screen.	Codes are valid for 10 minutes; request a new one from the verification screen.
Too many OTP attempts again.	A maximum of 5 attempts is allowed per code; request a new code and try again.
Can't sign in after registering	User accounts require admin approval; check status with your administrator.
Admin registration rejected platform administrator.	Confirm you are using the correct Admin Registration Key provided by your platform administrator.